



BBS Hybrid Seminar

Exploratory Subgroup Analyses in Clinical Trials

01 December 2026, 14:00 – 17:30 CET

F2F at [MC3](#) (Hegenheimermattweg 167D, Allschwil) & Virtual

Costs: Access to the seminar is free of charge, but registration is required: [Link](#)

Organizers: Björn Bornkamp (Novartis), Hans Ulrich Burger (Medizinische Universität Graz), Lilla Di Scala (J&J), Marcel Wolbers (Bayer), Markus Vogler (Viatris Innovation)

Abstract: Treatment effects may vary across subgroups, but distinguishing meaningful heterogeneity from chance findings remains a major challenge in clinical trials. This seminar will examine approaches to exploratory subgroup analyses, bringing together methodological, practical, and regulatory perspectives. Speakers from industry and regulatory agencies will discuss how subgroup findings can be explored and interpreted.

Agenda:

14:00	Exploratory Assessment of Treatment Effect Heterogeneity across Subgroups - Questions, Methods, Challenges - Bohdana Ratitch (Bayer)
14:30	Workflow to Assess Treatment Effect Heterogeneity (WATCH): Practical Lessons Learned – Björn Bornkamp & Claire Brittain (Novartis)
14:55	Improved treatment effect estimation in subgroups using shrinkage methods – Marcel Wolbers (Bayer)
15:20	Coffee Break
15:50	GMDS Biostatistics Competition “Reliable Subgroup Identification and Analysis”: motivating case study, key insights, and implications for future research/application – Heiko Götte (Merck)
16:15	Exploratory Subgroup Analyses: Case studies and regulatory considerations – Armin Schöler (BfArM)
16:40	Subgroup Analysis and Heterogeneous Treatment Effects – Mark Rothmann (FDA)
17:05	Discussion (until 17:30)